



ADVANCED ENGLISH COMMUNICATION SKILLS LAB B.Tech. III Year I Sem.

L T P C

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Introduction:

The introduction of the Advanced English Communication Skills Lab is considered essential at the B.Tech 3rd year level. At this stage, the students need to prepare themselves for their career which may require them to listen to, read, speak and write in English both for their professional and interpersonal communication in the globalised context. The proposed course should be a laboratory course to enable students to use appropriate English and perform the following:

1. Gathering ideas and information to organise ideas relevantly and coherently. 2. Making oral presentations. 3. Writing formal letters. 4. Transferring information from non-verbal to verbal texts and vice-versa. 5. Writing project/research reports/technical reports. 6. Participating in group discussions. 7. Engaging in debates. 8. Facing interviews. 9. Taking part in social and professional communication.

2. Objectives: This Lab focuses on using multi-media instruction for language development to meet the following targets:

- To improve the students' fluency in English, with a focus on vocabulary
- To enable them to listen to English spoken at normal conversational speed by educated English speakers
- To respond appropriately in different socio-cultural and professional contexts
- To communicate their ideas relevantly and coherently in writing
- To prepare the students for placements.

3. Syllabus: The following course content to conduct the activities is prescribed for the Advanced English Communication Skills (AECS) Lab:

1. Activities on Listening and Reading Comprehension: Active Listening – Development of Listening Skills Through Audio clips - Benefits of Reading – Methods and Techniques of Reading – Basic Steps to Effective Reading – Common Obstacles – Discourse Markers or Linkers - Sub-skills of reading - Reading for facts, negative facts and Specific Details- Guessing Meanings from Context, Inferring Meaning - Critical Reading — Reading Comprehension – Exercises for Practice.

2. Activities on Writing Skills: Vocabulary for Competitive Examinations - Planning for Writing – Improving Writing Skills - Structure and presentation of different types of writing –

Free Writing and Structured Writing - Letter Writing –Writing a Letter of Application –Resume vs. Curriculum Vitae – Writing a Résumé – Styles of Résumé - e-Correspondence – Emails – Blog Writing - (N)etiquette – Report Writing – Importance of Reports – Types and Formats of Reports– Technical Report Writing– Exercises for Practice.

3. Activities on Presentation Skills - Starting a conversation – responding appropriately and relevantly – using the right language and body language – Role Play in different situations including Seeking Clarification, Making a Request, Asking for and Refusing Permission, Participating in a Small Talk – Oral presentations (individual and group) through JAM sessions- PPTs – Importance of Presentation Skills – Planning, Preparing, Rehearsing and Making a Presentation – Dealing with R22 B.Tech. Mining Engg. Syllabus JNTU HYDERABAD Page 93 of 120 Glossophobia or Stage Fear – Understanding Nuances of Delivery - Presentations through Posters/Projects/Reports – Checklist for Making a Presentation and Rubrics of Evaluation

4. Activities on Group Discussion (GD): Types of GD and GD as a part of a Selection Procedure - Dynamics of Group Discussion- Myths of GD - Intervention, Summarizing - Modulation of Voice, Body Language, Relevance, Fluency and Organization of Ideas – Do's and Don'ts - GD Strategies – Exercises for Practice.

5. Interview Skills: Concept and Process - Interview Preparation Techniques - Types of Interview Questions – Pre-interview Planning, Opening Strategies, Answering Strategies - Interview Through Tele-conference & Video-conference - Mock Interviews.

4. Minimum Requirement: The Advanced English Communication Skills (AECS) Laboratory shall have the following infrastructural facilities to accommodate at least 35 students in the lab: • Spacious room with appropriate acoustics • Round Tables with movable chairs • Audio-visual aids • LCD Projector • Public Address system • One PC with latest configuration for the teacher • T. V, a digital stereo & Camcorder • Headphones of High quality 5. Suggested Software: The software consisting of the prescribed topics elaborated above should be procured and used. • TOEFL & GRE (KAPLAN, AARCO & BARRONS, USA, Cracking GRE by CLIFFS) • Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary, 10th Edition • Cambridge Advanced Learner's Dictionary • DELTA's key to the Next Generation TOEFL Test: Advanced Skill Practice. • Lingua TOEFL CBT Insider, by Dreamtech 6. Books Recommended: 1. Rizvi, M. Ashraf (2018). Effective Technical Communication. (2nd ed.). McGraw Hill Education (India) Pvt. Ltd. 2. Suresh Kumar, E. (2015). Engineering English. Orient BlackSwan Pvt. Ltd. 3. Bailey, Stephen. (2018). Academic Writing: A Handbook for International Students. (5th Edition). Routledge. 4. Koneru, Aruna. (2016). Professional Communication. McGraw Hill Education (India) Pvt. Ltd. 5. Raman, Meenakshi & Sharma, Sangeeta. (2022). Technical Communication, Principles and Practice. (4TH Edition) Oxford University Press. 6. Anderson, Paul V. (2007). Technical Communication. Cengage Learning Pvt. Ltd. New Delhi. 7. McCarthy, Michael; O'Dell, Felicity & Redman, Stuart. (2017). English Vocabulary in Use Series. Cambridge University Press 8. Sen, Leela. (2009). Communication Skills. PHI Learning Pvt Ltd., New Delhi. 9. Elbow, Peter. (1998). Writing with Power. Oxford University Press. 10. Goleman, Daniel. (2013).

UNIT-1

Activities on Listening and Reading Comprehension: Active Listening – Development of Listening Skills Through Audio clips - Benefits of Reading – Methods and Techniques of Reading – Basic Steps to Effective Reading – Common Obstacles – Discourse Markers or Linkers - Sub-skills of reading - Reading for facts, negative facts and Specific Details- Guessing Meanings from Context, Inferring Meaning - Critical Reading — Reading Comprehension – Exercises for Practice.

Active Listening Skills

Active listening requires you to listen attentively to a speaker, understand what they're saying, respond and reflect on what's being said, and retain the information for later.

This keeps both listener and speaker actively engaged in the conversation.

Active listening and reflecting, responding, and giving feedback aren't always easy. Here are some helpful active listening tips for managers:

- Pay close attention to the speaker's behaviour and body language to gain a better understanding of their message.
- Signal that you're following along with visual cues like nodding and eye contact; ask clarifying questions to ensure your understanding.
- Avoid potential interruptions — from technology (e.g., phone or email notifications) and from humans (e.g., knocks on your door).
- Keep an open mind. Rather than evaluating the message and offering an opinion, simply make the speaker feel heard and validated.
- Confirm you've understood what the speaker has said by verifying your understanding.
- Be an attentive listener and have your tool kit of active listening techniques at the ready for whenever [conversations](#) occur.

Development of Listening Skills through Audio clips

INTRODUCTION

Listening skills have only begun to gain attention in language learning in the recent decades. Traditionally, it is mistakenly assumed that listening skills can be acquired naturally without formal instructions, just as how children acquire their mother tongues through listening to daily conversations (Miller, 2003). Despite seeming like a receptive and passive skill, studies, however, showed that listening skills should be explicitly taught, especially in second or foreign language classrooms. Listening is the key for learning to take place as they help one to receive and process input. However, before learners listen to learn, they have to learn to listen. As Rose and Dalton (2016) claimed, one has to learn much to become a skillful listener.

Listening skill has been an under-emphasized skill in many English as a Second Language (ESL) classrooms until recent decades. To keep up with the global advancement of technology, many studies on listening skills have integrated use of technology. In Malaysia, listening skills are also

often neglected due to the highly examination-oriented education system. Since communication and technology competence are important 21st century skills, learners should be exposed to listening skills using no less than multimedia, especially when technology is inaccessible in rural parts of the country. This paper aims to examine the perceptions of teachers and pupils in using audio clips to develop listening comprehension skills in a rural primary school in Sarawak, East Malaysia, where digital facilities and internet connection are lacking in many parts of the state. Focus group interviews were conducted with two teachers and three ESL pupils after six weekly listening activities using audio clips based on the textbooks. Findings indicated that the teachers found audio clips to be useful and convenient, while pupils exhibited more interest and concentration during lessons. All respondents believed that audio clips could encourage the development of listening comprehension skills. Finally, it is recommended that audio clips could be expanded into a listening module that slowly moves towards authentic listening to equip learners with real-world skills and experiences.

How can you develop your listening skills?

10 tips for active listening

1. Face the speaker and have eye contact. ...
2. "Listen" to non-verbal cues too. ...
3. Do not interrupt. ...
4. Listen without judging, or jumping to conclusions. ...
5. Do not start planning what to say next. ...
6. Show that you're listening. ...
7. Do not impose your opinions or solutions. ...
8. Stay focused.

Reading Comprehension Benefits of Reading

Objectives:

- ☐ To improve the reading comprehension skills of students
- ☐ To make them adept in the sub skills of reading i.e., skimming, scanning, inference etc.

Introduction

"Reading" is the process of looking at a series of written symbols and getting meaning from them. When we read, we use our eyes to receive written symbols (letters, punctuation marks and spaces) and we use our brain to convert them into words, sentences and paragraphs that communicate something to us. Reading ability is determined by many factors, and requires the development of certain skills through early reading instruction to attain initial success and build on it. This unit will be conducted in one session.

Your physical body requires nutrition, exercise and sleep to stay healthy and function properly. Similarly, to keep your mind healthy and functioning, you need to feed it, exercise it, and give it rest. One activity that does all three is reading. In this section, let us look at the benefits and importance of reading.

Reading develops your language abilities, which is essential for communication (which, in turn, is essential for thriving in any kind of social group). One cannot consider oneself fluent in a language unless one is able to read effectively in that language. The best way to learn how to use any language to understand the grammar of the language and to expand one's vocabulary-is not through textbooks but through extensive reading. Textbooks are limited in scope, but well-written books provide multiple models of how to correctly use words in a variety of contexts. Naturally, it follows from this that reading is a crucial component of learning to write well also. Instruction manuals on how to write can help you with your writing up to a point. Only when you read a wide variety of good writing will you truly begin to understand how to write well and how to adapt your writing style to the form you have chosen to write in. Therefore, read plenty of well-written books: it is an enjoyable way to imbibe the principles of good communication, both written and oral.

Reading is also one of the best ways of learning the things that you want to or need to know. More often than not, sadly, it is not possible to learn from direct experience due to limitations of time or resources. Thankfully, there are books and written resources on nearly every subject imaginable, and these can help you acquire the knowledge you want or need. Good reading comprehension means that you will be able to teach yourself the things you need later in life.

Reading develops your imagination and inspires creativity. Creativity and imagination are necessary not just for artists but for everyone, because these are problem-solving tools and are applicable to all areas of life.

Expanding your language abilities, knowledge and imagination improves your reasoning and analytical abilities. Thus, reading also sharpens critical thinking.

The sustained reading of longer texts (essays, novels, etc.) helps develop focus and the ability to concentrate. The ability to focus is a superpower in today's world of distraction and short attention spans, and reading is perhaps the most enjoyable way to build this superpower.

Reading for pleasure reduces stress and anxiety by temporarily shifting your attention from a Stress-inducing situation. A stress-free mind is better able to resolve the issue that caused the stress in the first place. Read something that you find entertaining and fun to lift your mood.

Reading is a skill that is fundamental to functioning in today's society. Many workplaces (and certainly most well-paying jobs) require you to understand and respond to written texts of various lengths and complexity (from reports to e-mails and memos). Better reading comprehension will reduce the time it takes to understand what is required of you, and help you to communicate effectively and work efficiently.

Methods and Techniques of Reading

Theory

Reading is an important communicative process and reading skills are probably the most important language skills required for academic and professional purposes. Depending on the purpose of reading, the reader will require different reading strategies and skills in order to understand the subject content and language patterns of a message. There are three types of reading skills.

These skills include:

- ☐ Vocabulary skills,
- ☐ Rapid reading skills
- ☐ Intensive reading skills.

Vocabulary skills:

These skills include word meaning recognition, identifying the context clues and signal words ,guessing the meaning of unknown words from word structure and context. The reader needs to look for the contextual signal words, examples, illustrations and linguistic clues that indirectly help define an unknown word or phrase. For instance, notice the signal clue in the following sentence

Although she is very loquacious, she remains silent before her father.

The word ‘although’ contrasts the word ‘loquacious’ with the words ‘remains silent’ and the reader can guess that the word ‘loquacious’ means someone who talks a lot and does not remain silent.

Rapid reading skills

Reading is an active process and reader approaches the text for a particular reason. This refers to a set of reading practices which help in understanding the meaning of a given text. These skills include scanning and skimming.

Scanning:

Scanning refers to the ability to locate specific information or facts as quickly as possible. It may serve several purposes, which include looking for:

- ☐ a specific point or fact in text
- ☐ relevant graphic detail
- ☐ a formulae in text
- ☐ a word in a dictionary etc.

We may know how to scan a newspaper or a dictionary but may do it slowly with less accuracy. Scanning speed can be increased by regular practice and concentration. The following suggestions will help increase proficiency at scanning.

- ☐ know what you want to find
- ☐ do not read everything
- ☐ use guides and aids
- ☐ know the organization of the material to be read
- ☐ concentrate while scanning

Skimming:

Skimming is a more sophisticated skill than scanning. It refers to the process of reading a text or passage in order to get a rough idea of what it is all about. As its main objective is to understand the central idea and the main points of a text, the reader needs to use a reading strategy that

involves fast reading and quick analysis.

Skimming involves three main skills:

- i) Identifying the central idea
- ii) Recognizing main ideas
- iii) Identifying the writing patterns of the passage/text

Intensive reading skills

Intensive reading is detailed reading that demands better concentration and motivation. The rapid reading techniques of scanning and skimming give the readers correct beginning and prepare them for intensive reading.

Intensive reading skills include:

A. Critical reading

Distinguishing between relevant and irrelevant information
Explicit and implicit information

B. Inferring meaning

To understand facts and opinions
Drawing inferences and conclusions

Inferring meaning and Critical reading:

Inferring means using content in a text, together with existing knowledge, to come to a personal conclusion about something that is not stated explicitly in the text. When the author provides clues but not all the information, we read “between the lines” to make predictions, revise these, understand underlying themes, hypothesize, make critical judgments, and draw conclusions. Inferring involves synthesizing information, sometimes quite simply and sometimes at complex levels.

Critical reading is an analytic activity. The reader rereads a text to identify patterns of elements - information, values, assumptions, and language usage-- throughout the discussion. These elements are tied together in an interpretation, an assertion of an underlying meaning of the text as a whole.

The SQ3R Method

SQ3R is a five-step reading comprehension method that trains your mind to focus on what you are reading in order to better understand and retain information from material. The abbreviation SQ3R stands for Survey, Question, Read, Recite and Review, the steps that constitute the process.

SQ3R was specifically developed as a technique for reading study materials (like textbooks), but useful for all kinds of expository, argumentative, or information-dense texts. The sequence in SQ3R is designed to make you read actively, with intention, rather than passively. The purpose of SQ3R is to make effective use of the time and effort spent reading information that needs to be understood, absorbed and recalled.

The SQ3R method is outlined below. The steps in the process should be followed in the given order.

1. Survey

Do not dive in and begin reading immediately-instead, skim through the material first to get a general idea of what it is about.

Look at (a) the title. (b) headings and sub-headings, (c) tables, graphs, charts, images, and (d) text that is highlighted or set apart (abstracts, objectives, summaries, points to remember, etc.).

Don't spend too much time on this step: five minutes or less is sufficient.

2. Question

Based on the information you have picked up through your quick survey (as well as your prior knowledge of the subject), ask yourself questions about what you are about to read.

Examples of questions to ask yourself are: What is this book, chapter, etc. going to be about? What do I already know about this subject! What is the author's purpose in writing this? Why am I reading this (or, what is my goal)? How will this benefit me?

You can convert the heading of each sub-section into a question. For example, after skimming through Unit 4 of this textbook, some questions you could ask yourself about the current section are: Have I come across the term 'SQ3R' before? What is the SQ3R method? It looks like an abbreviation-what does it stand for? Why is this topic in the "Reading section of this chapter? What does it have to do with reading skills?

The purpose of this step is to warm up your mind, to prepare and engage your mind, so that it is ready to read in an active (rather than a passive) manner. One is usually more alert than usual when one is looking for something in this case, answers to the questions you have formulated. You are tricking your mind into activating itself.

3. Read

After you have completed the first two steps, you can finally begin actually reading the material.

Read the book, chapter, etc. section by section instead of all at once.

As you read each section, keep in mind the questions you had formulated during the previous step, and look for answers to those questions.

While reading, more questions may arise in your mind; keep looking for answers to those questions within the current section (and in later sections).

TIP: It would be even better if you could write down all your questions in a notebook.

Answering these questions as you read will help you engage with the text and identify critical information contained within it.

The current section may not answer all the questions that spring to your mind: that's okay. Just try and identify the answers that are present in the current part of the text.

4. Recite

When you reach the end of the current section, pause, and repeat (recite) to yourself what you remember from that section.

Recall the headings, the main points, and the answers to your questions.

If you can't remember these points, look at the text again, and repeat your attempt to recollect the information.

TIPS: Try reciting the main points out aloud to yourself, or even to someone else (such as a study partner) as though you are explaining it to them (or to yourself). As much as possible, use your own words when doing so, instead of repeating the words of the text verbatim. You can paraphrase and summarise the information. You can create written (or picture or audio) notes. All of these tips will boost your long-term memory of what you have just read.

Move on to the next section (of the book, chapter, etc.) only after you are successful at this step.

5. Review

After you finish reading the entire material (i.e., after you complete the READ and RECITE stages for each section of the material), it is time to review everything you have learnt.

Try to recall from memory (a) the main points of the material, and (b) answers to all the questions had formulated.

Review (as well as correct, update and expand) your notes. Re-read those parts of the material you found difficult. Check to see if there are any gaps in your understanding of the material make a note of those.

The SQ3R method may seem slow at first, but do not feel discouraged. It will save you time and effort long run, compared to reading passively and without focus, letting your eyes glare over the extra effort involved in the SQ3R method will supercharge your learning.

Strategies for Effective Reading

Most of the time, we read to get something from the material we are reading to figure out an answer to a question, to learn how something works. Reading comprehension is a key skill because you can make use of written material only when you understand what it says. When reading for a purpose, your mind needs to be active. Here are some strategies to help you activate your mind and get more out of the texts that you read.

1. Before you begin, ask yourself why you are reading the text. Is it to dig out a specific piece information? To understand the overall meaning of what is being said? To judge the quality the text or its argument? The purpose of reading will determine whether you need to scan (lo for specific information), skim (read quickly to get the gist), or read closely (to understand the text in detail).

2. Other useful questions that you can ask yourself before you begin reading are:

1. What will this text most likely be about?
2. What do I know about this topic?
3. How is this text likely to develop the topic?

3. Get an overview of the structure of the written matter. This will prime your mind to grasp the material faster.

1. Look at the headings and sub-headings.
2. Skim through the first and last paragraphs.
3. Look at highlighted words or points.
4. Read the captions on images, graphs and tables.

4. When reading, pay special attention to how the central idea or main theme is developed throughout the course of the text. How does the author begin? How does the author end the text? Do the parts that come in between connect the two in a natural, logical manner?

5. Identify (and mark with a pencil) the areas that required devoted reading, on the parts which you didn't understand. You can re-visit these sections of the text later.

6. Think about the author's point of view and bias. (What is the author's purpose in writing the text?)

7. After your initial reading, reflect on whether the content was similar to or different from your (pre-reading) idea of what it was going to be.

8. Re-read the difficult or important lines and paragraphs.

What are the obstacles in reading?

Barriers to Reading

- Lack of concentration.
- Uninteresting subject matter.
- Lack of motivation.
- Faulty reading habits.
- Defective Reading.
- Indiscriminate use of the dictionary.

Common problems in people with reading disorder include:

- Slow reading speed.
- Poor comprehension when reading material either aloud or silently.
- Omission of words while reading.
- Reversal of words or letters while reading.
- Difficulty decoding syllables or single words and associating them with specific sounds (phonics)

Discourse Markers or Linkers

Discourse markers are words and phrases that are used to manage and organize the structure of discourse. They connect sentences without changing the general meaning of what is being said. Discourse markers are also known as linking words, linking phrases or sentence connectors.

Why is it important to use discourse markers or linking words?

Discourse markers are used to organize and manage what we are saying using words and phrases to connect ideas and to express how we feel about what we are saying. They are also used to help you think about what to say next using fillers correctly to sound natural in your delivery.

Discourse markers are words or expressions that link, manage and help to organize sentences. They connect what is written or said with something else. They make no change to the meaning.

They are also often called linking words and, sometimes, *fillers*. They are important to make your speech or text flow and to avoid a series of short unconnected statements.

Discourse markers can be placed in any part of a sentence, including the beginning. We use different types of *discourse markers* for different types of links; informal markers for speech and formal type markers for formal writing, such as essays and reports.

Discourse markers do not always have meanings that you will find in your dictionary. Instead, they provide certain functions such as delaying, filling or hinting at emotions.

Discourse markers are important for fluency in English at an advanced level. They are important elements of speech and writing for living and working in English-speaking countries.

When speaking or informal writing, such as emails or texts to friends, the following discourse markers are often used. There are many of course, but here are some of the most common.

- **Anyway** – marks a shift away from a topic. *It's sold out, anyway, I didn't want to go.*
- **Actually** – indicates that what you are saying is a surprise to you or is the opposite of what might be imagined or introduces the opposite response to what someone wants or expects. *I thought I didn't like dance shows but actually, I quite enjoyed it. Actually, I'd prefer if you didn't smoke in here.*
- **As I was saying / As I said** – continuing a theme after a change of subject. *As I was saying before I was interrupted, I'd like to go to the cinema. As I said last week, I don't enjoy opera.*
- **Absolutely** – used as a stronger way of saying yes. *A. Would you like a holiday in Thailand? B. Absolutely, when do we go?*
- **Exactly** – used to emphasise what you mean. *What exactly are you talking about? Exactly, that's what I meant.*
- **Okay or OK** – understood or agreed. *Okay, I get it.*
- **Well** – used to indicate an emotion including annoyance, anger, surprise, disappointment and relief. *Well, that's not what I wanted to hear. Well, I didn't expect that!*
- **Fine** – used informally to indicate that something is not good. *That's another fine mess you've got me into. A. How are you since your wife left you? B, Fine, what do you think*
- **Mind (you)** – used to highlight or stress something you said to avoid misunderstanding. *He couldn't help me, mind you, I know he's busy so it's not his fault. Or to introduce something else that needs to be considered. My kids never listen to me. Mind you, I didn't either at their age so I guess it's normal.*

- **You know** – indicates that what you're saying is known by the listener. or to check they understand with a question mark. Also used as a filler while you're thinking of what to say next. *Studying economics is hard, you know.*
- **I mean** – introduces a statement to justify what you've said. *It was a tough driving test, I mean I took my test in the rush hour in the rain.*
- **For a start** – introduces the first item of a logical sequence or the most important item of other possibilities. *The driving test in Spain is difficult, for a start it's all in Spanish.*
- **What's more** – introduces a new fact or argument and implies that this new fact or argument is more important than the one just given. Used without contraction for formal speech and writing. *The stock market fell in 2008 and what's more, our pension fund was tied up in stocks.*
- **On top of that** – used to indicate something unpleasant in addition to what you've just said. *I lost my job and on top of that, I was fined for speeding.*
- **To tell you the truth/truth be told** – indicates that what you're saying is honest and open. *To tell you the truth, I was more than a little worried. Truth be told, I'm concerned about the project*
- **To be honest** – explains that you are being truthful about what you're saying, usually with an understanding that the person you're talking to will be disappointed. *To be honest, I don't think your offer is sufficient.*
- **Sort of / kind of** – used to describe that something is partly true but it's not the entire explanation. Or that something is difficult to explain entirely. *Your answer is sort of correct but there's a bit more to it than that. My new car is a kind of blue-green colour. Not sure what colour you'd call it.*

FORMAL AND WRITTEN DISCOURSE MARKERS

Discourse markers for more formal writing situations organize your text logically. They are typical when writing formal letters or when writing essays or reports, especially at work. They will also be used in formal speaking situations, such as presentations or speeches.

Firstly, secondly and thirdly – organize your points logically. *Firstly we need to reduce the prices of the products. Secondly, we need to upgrade the channel to market etc. etc.*

- **Finally** – marks the final point of a list. *Finally, I want to talk about the environment.*
- To begin with –
- **In addition** – provides extra information. *In addition to my earlier point, we also need to think about delivery.*
- **In conclusion** – marks the summary and round-up of your essay or speech. *In conclusion, I have demonstrated that savings will be 10%.*
- **In summary** – another way to mark the conclusion. *In summary, the average costs will reduce.*
- **Moreover** – as a further matter, there is even more to tell you. *Moreover, they would have to move home.*
- **On (the) one hand, on the other hand** – introduces two opposing ideas. *On the one hand, it's cheaper, on the other hand, it means a lot of work to make it worth the trouble.*
- **What is more** – introduces a new fact or argument and implies that this new fact or argument is more important than the one just given. Used with contraction for informal. *The stock market fell in 2008, what is more, is that the company had all its assets in stocks.*

- **Furthermore** – introduces an additional fact or argument. *Unemployment rates fell in 2018, furthermore, average salaries rose.*
- **Not only....but also** – used to give emphasis to a second point. This phrase uses **inversions**. *I not only worked in London but also in Paris.*
- **For example** – used to give an example to show that something is true. *This will never work, for example the spring is broken.*
- **Such as** – introduces an example or examples of what you're talking about. *There are lots of types of car on the road today, such as saloons, hatchbacks and four-by-fours.*
- **As a result** – introduces what happened because of something. *He failed his exams and, as a result, couldn't attend university.*
- **Consequently** – because of this or as a result. *The road is closed, consequently we'll need to wait until it's open again.*
- **Nevertheless** – despite what has just been said or written. *There are insufficient funds for the development, nevertheless, we'll continue the work and hope something turns up.*
- **By/in contrast** – a comparison which introduces something opposite to the first item. *The economy in the EU shrunk by 2%, by contrast, the USA saw growth of nearly 5%.*
- **In comparison** – used to discuss the ways in which two things are different. *Costs have risen in comparison to last year.*
- **In my opinion** – Used to give your opinion or point of view when you are confident of the facts. *In my opinion, it's better to invest in language training as early as possible in our schools.*
- **Of course** – stating something that is known or obvious but it's important to mention anyway. *Of course, children benefit greatly from playing sports.*

Exercises for Practice

Tests of reading comprehension usually ask you questions on the following:

1. Your general understanding of the content
2. Your understanding of specific pieces of information or sections of the text The author's opinions and point of view
3. What may be inferred from the passage (as opposed to what is explicitly stated)
4. Always read the entire passage before attempting to answer questions set on it.

Exercise 1

Read the following passage and answer the questions:

1. A leading Indian industrialist in a recent article on ways to strengthen India's economy has drawn attention to the problems of inflation and industrial sickness among other things. One of the main reasons for industrial sickness in our country has been the fact that business and industrial managers have not been able to look beyond the immediate future. They have been too preoccupied with their attempts to report favourable results for the current year - higher profits and larger dividends to the shareholders. The planning horizon has hardly ever exceeded five years. Investments have been inadequate for new plants and towards diversification and expansions. Modernization and asset creation has seriously lagged behind. In business, growth is needed for survival; one has to grow if one does not want to be wiped out. This is particularly true today with liberalization of imports and increasing competition. Moreover, growth and

higher productivity create employment and higher employment creates larger markets both for industrial and consumer products. It was Henry Ford who brought home the need for the creation of a larger and more stable middle class, that is, a larger number of people who can afford more and more of goods and services. Even after forty years of independence our industrialists have not been able to shed the petty shopkeeper's mentality and our highly educated management has tagged along merrily and without concern.

1. What, according to the writer is the main reason for industrial sickness in our country?
2. What have the managers been preoccupied with?
3. According to the passage, what do growth and increasing productivity lead to?
4. Why did Henry Ford stress the need for a more stable middle class?
5. (a) Explain the phrase 'wipe out'
(b) Find a word from the passage which means the same as 'small' or unimportant'.

Exercise 2

Read the following texts. Answer the questions that follow in just one sentence each. Keep your answers brief, but at the same time clear and complete.

A generator is essentially just an electric motor working in reverse. An electric motor consists of a tight coil of copper wire wrapped around an iron core that's free to rotate at high speed inside a powerful permanent magnet. When you feed electricity into the copper coil, it becomes a temporary, electrically powered magnet-in other words, an electromagnet-and generates a magnetic field all around it. This temporary magnetic field pushes against the magnetic field that the permanent magnet creates and forces the coil to rotate. By a bit of clever design, the coil can be made to rotate continuously in the same direction, spinning round and round and powering anything from an electric toothbrush to an electric train.

So how is a generator different? Suppose you have an electric toothbrush with a rechargeable battery inside. Instead of letting the battery power the motor that pushes the brush, what if you did the opposite? What if you turned the brush back and forth repeatedly? What you'd be doing would be manually turning the electric motor's axle. That would make the copper coil inside the motor turn around repeatedly inside its permanent magnet. If you move an electric wire inside a magnetic field, you make electricity flow through the wire-in effect, you generate electricity. Keep turning the toothbrush long enough and, in theory, you would generate enough electricity to recharge its battery. That, in effect, is how a generator works.

1. What is this text about?
2. Where are electric motors used?
3. What is the purpose of a generator?
4. How can you create a simple electro magnet?
5. Mention two differences between a generator and an electric motor.
6. Is the author's personal opinion on the subject mentioned in the text? (If yes, what is it?)

Exercise 3

I think that at that time none of us quite believed in the Time Machine. The fact is, the Time Traveller was one of those men who are too clever to be believed: you never felt that you saw all round him, you always suspected some subtle reserve, some ingenuity in ambush, behind his lucid frankness. Had Filly shown the model and explained the matter in the Time Traveller's

words, we should have shown him far less scepticism. For we should have perceived his motives: a pork-butcher could understand Filby. But the Time Traveller had more than a touch of whim among his elements, and we distrusted him. Things that would have made the fame of a less clever man seemed tricks in his hands. It is a mistake to do things too easily. The serious people who took him seriously never felt quite sure of his deportment, they were somehow aware that trusting their reputations for judgement with him was like furnishing a nursery with eggshell china. So I don't think any of us said very much about time travelling in the interval between that Thursday and the next, though its odd potentialities ran, no doubt, in most of our minds: its plausibility. that is, its practical incredibleness, the curious possibilities of anachronism and of utter confusion suggested. For my own part, I was particularly preoccupied with the trick of the model.

-H.G. Wells, The Time Machine

1. What do you think this text about?
 2. What do you think is the narrator's opinion about the Time Traveller?
 3. Why does the narrator say 'It's a mistake to do things too easily'?
 4. What does the phrase 'furnishing a nursery with eggshell china' mean in this context?
 5. From this excerpt, what impressions do you form about the narrator, Filby and the Time
-

UNIT-2.

Activities on Writing Skills:

What are writing skills?

Writing is a technical skill that you use to communicate effectively through the written word. Though these may vary depending on what you're writing, there are several that transcend categories. Writing skills can more specifically include:

Grammar, Vocabulary, Spelling, Sentence construction, Structure, Research and accuracy, Clarity, and Persuasiveness.

Each of these components can influence the quality of writing.

Why are writing skills important?

Being able to write well is a form of effective communication, which many employers see as a crucial job skill. In fact, strong communication—spanning written, verbal, non-verbal, and visual—is among the nine common employability skills that employers seek in job candidates.

Regardless of your role, with good writing skills, you can clearly transcribe your thoughts into meaningful messages, enabling you to share your ideas, build relationships, and strengthen your professional image. Writing skills are essential in the corporate world to execute decisive action and provide clear instruction. In order to function smoothly, businesses need to send and receive information at an internal, regional and international level. Writing skills allow people to connect without physically being present in a room. The ability to articulate your point effectively saves time and company resources.

How to improve your writing skills

Writing, like any other skill, is something we can get better at with time and practice. Here are some strategies for developing your own written communication:

1. Review grammar and spelling basics.

Grammar and spelling form the foundation of good writing. It also makes your writing easier to understand.

2. Read what you want to write.

Knowing what a finished piece of writing can look like can guide your own. Make reading a part of your everyday life to improve your writing.

3. Proofread.

Read out loud. Reading out loud can help you find awkward phrases and areas where your writing doesn't flow well.

4. Get feedback.

Whether you're writing emails or essays, asking for feedback is a great way to see how somebody besides yourself will interpret your text.

5. Think about structure.

6. Write.

Like many skills, one of the best ways to improve your writing is to practice. Here are a few ways you can get started:

Start a journal or a blog. Join a class or writing workshop. Practice free writing. Write letters to friends or family. Put together an opinion piece for your local newspaper or publication you like.

How to improve your writing skills

Here are our 10 tips to help you improve your writing skills:

1. Think before you write
2. Do your research
3. Create an outline
4. Understand your audience
5. Keep it simple
6. Cut down filler words
7. Improve your word choice
8. Use simple vocabulary
9. Avoid contractions

Indian English does not use contractions. So while writing, use "I am" instead of "I'm", "you are" instead of "you're", "cannot" instead of "can't", "will not" instead of "won't", "have not" instead of "haven't", "we will" instead of "we'll" and "did not" instead of "didn't" to make your writing clear.

Writing Prompts:

You just received an unexpected package at your doorstep. What's in it?

You discover a time machine. Where would you go? What happens there?

What does your ideal day look like?

Think about a major decision you made. What would have happened if you had chosen a different path?

Write a letter to your past or future self.

Free writing and structured writing:

About Free Writing

Free writing is a technique where you write continuously without worrying about grammar, spelling, or structure. The goal is to let your thoughts flow freely and explore your innermost feelings and ideas. It's a form of uninhibited self-expression that allows you to tap into your subconscious mind and access deeper layers of creativity. Free writing can be helpful for brainstorming, capturing raw emotions, and overcoming writer's block. It's a non-judgmental process that encourages spontaneity and exploration.

Free writing is the type of journaling you do when you simply pick up your pen and write.

Structured Writing:

Structured writing, on the other hand, involves a more organized and planned approach to journaling. It follows a specific framework or template, such as prompts, questions, or guided exercises. This method provides a structured framework to focus your thoughts and reflections. Structured writing can be useful for goal-setting, self-reflection, gratitude practice, or specific self-improvement exercises. It helps bring clarity, intentionality, and a sense of direction to your journaling practice.

Letter Writing:

A letter is a written message that can be handwritten or printed on paper. It is usually sent to the recipient via mail or post in an envelope, although this is not a requirement as such. Any such message that is transferred via post is a letter, a written conversation between two parties.

Now that Emails and texts and other such forms have become the norm for communication, the art of letter writing has taken a backseat. However, even today a lot of our communication, especially the formal kind, is done via letters. Whether it is a cover letter for a job, or the bank sending you a reminder or a college acceptance letter, letters are still an important mode of communication. This is why it is important that we know the intricacies of letter writing.

Types of Letters

Let us first understand that there are broadly two types of letter, namely Formal Letters, and Informal Letters. But then there are also a few types of letters based on their contents, formalities, the purpose of letter writing etc. Let us have a look at the few types of letters.

Formal Letter: These letters follow a certain pattern and formality. They are strictly kept professional in nature, and directly address the issues concerned. Any type of business letter or letter to authorities falls within this given category.

Informal Letter: These are personal letters. They need not follow any set pattern or adhere to any formalities. They contain personal information or are a written conversation. Informal letters are generally written to friends, acquaintances, relatives etc.

Business Letter: This letter is written among business correspondents, generally contains commercial information such as quotations, orders, complaints, claims, letters for collections etc. Such letters are always strictly formal and follow a structure and pattern of formalities.

Official Letter: This type of letter is written to inform offices, branches, subordinates of official information. It usually relays official information like rules, regulations, procedures, events, or any other such information. Official letters are also formal in nature and follow certain structure and decorum.

Social Letter: A personal letter written on the occasion of a special event is known as a social letter. Congratulatory letter, condolence letter, invitation letter etc are all social letters.

Circular Letter: A letter that announces information to a large number of people is a circular letter. The same letter is circulated to a large group of people to correspond some important information like a change of address, change in management, the retirement of a partner etc.

Employment Letters: Any letters with respect to the employment process, like joining letter, promotion letter, application letter etc.

Let us discuss the types of formal letter –

1. Letter to the editor
2. Letter to the Government
3. Letter to the police
4. Letter to the principal
5. Order letter
6. Complaint letter
7. Inquiry letter
8. Business letter
9. Application letter

Writing a Job Application Letter – What Recruiters Expect?

Every individual needs a job that pays them well so as to be able to live a comfortable life. In this competitive world, people find it really hard to get themselves placed in a good company due to the little things they thought were not that important and did not take into consideration. According to many, how you perform at the interview is all that matters, but that is not true. The employer builds an opinion about you from the very beginning. From the time you send in your job application, or your profile gets noticed on an online platform, the employer notices each and every little detail. Your job

application letter is one of the first things that create an impression about you in the eyes of the recruiter, so it is vital that you understand how to write a job application letter and draft a good one.

Formal Letter of Job Application for the Position of Cryptographer

589/22, Srilakshmi Nagar Block 3

Subbanna Palya Extension

Banaswadi, Bangalore North

560023

January 7, 2022

The HR Manager

Anton Technologies

Electronic City

Bangalore – 560012

Respected Sir,

Subject: Job application letter for the position of Cryptographer

This is with reference to the job posting on LinkedIn for the position of Cryptographer in your esteemed organisation. I have carefully read the job description. I have also browsed through your official website to understand the kind of work you do, and I am interested in working with you.

I am a B.Tech Electronics graduate, and I have completed multiple diploma courses in Cyber Security. I have hands-on experience of working in the field of cyber security for five years. Planning and executing various security means, analysing and documenting security systems, rebuilding and making arrangements for the safety of the security system, writing and developing security codes are some of the areas I have good experience with. I believe that I will be a good fit for the role in your company and that I can do justice to the responsibilities I will have to take up.

I have enclosed my resume and work samples for your kind review.

Thank you for your time and consideration. Hoping to hear from you.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

BIPIN DAS

Job Application Mail Template

Receiver's mail id: name.234@email.com

Respected Sir/Ma'am,

Subject: Job Application for the Role of (Mention the job role you are applying for)

I am (Mention your full name) and I would like to apply for the role of (Job role) at your prestigious company.

I have completed my (Mention your degree) in (Mention the subject/specialisation). I have (Mention the years of experience) years of experience in the field of (Mention the field of work) at (Mention the name of your previous company). I have an in depth knowledge of the duties that I will have to perform and expertise in the particular field of work that would help me accomplish all the assigned tasks in the event of me being placed in your company.

I have enclosed herewith my resume, my detailed profile and a certificate of experience for your reference and review. I have also provided my contact information. Please feel free to contact me in case of any questions. I am looking forward to meeting with you in person for an interview.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Your full name

Contact number : 123456

Email id: name.name@email.com

Sample for Job Application Letter 1 – Applying as a Fresher/Graduate

142, 12th Floor,

Vibrant Tower,

Andheri, Mumbai.

12th September 2021

To,

The HR Manager,

ABC Technologies,

Action Tower,

Mumbai.

Respected Ma'am,

Subject: Job application for the position of Software Engineer

I hope your day is going great. I am writing this to you regarding the software engineer position that has recently opened up in your company. I came across this position on a website and I believe that I qualify for the majority of the requirements.

I have completed my graduation in electronic communication from IIT Delhi in which I hold a CGPA of 8.65. During my graduation, I also pursued certificate courses in Java processing, front-end development and backend development.

I also recently completed a three-month internship with Sigma Technologies where I was a part of their front-end team.

I have attached my resume with this letter and I certainly believe my educational qualifications will be satisfactory as per your expectations and will meet all the requirements.

Looking forward to discussing my skill set in an interview.

Thanking you,

Yours truly,

Sakshi Mittal

Question: Write a job application mail to the HR manager, Wipro to accept your candidature for the future job vacancy.

Résumé vs Curriculum Vitaé

What is a CV?

The term CV is an abbreviation of the Latin word Curriculum Vitaé, which is literally translated to “the course of your life”.

A CV is a very in-depth document that describes your career journey step-by-step, including all sorts of personal information. You can look at the CV as a comprehensive description of everything you have ever done, all the achievements you are proud of, and all the publications that bear your name.

You need to update your CV every time you accomplish something new academically or professionally. Meaning, whenever you get a new job, publish something new, obtain a new certificate, and so on.

What’s the Difference?

Now that you have a clear idea about what’s a CV and what’s a resume, here’s a complete list of the differences between the curriculum vitae (CV) and résumé:

Type of information you include - The CV is an academic diary where you include all your academic qualifications, achievements, and certifications. It is universal in nature as it can be updated as you go.

Whereas, a resume has to be created (or at least customized) for each job you're applying for, and has a bigger focus on your professional achievements, rather than academic.

There is no rule of thumb on how long a CV should be - depending on the amount of experience, it can range from 2 to 8 pages.

1. Full name
2. Contact information
3. Professional title, resume summary, or resume objective
4. Research interests
5. Education
6. Publications (both academic papers and books)
7. Teaching or lecturing experience
8. Work experience
9. Conferences and courses
10. Skills
11. Certificates
12. Languages
13. Grants of fellowships
14. References

What is a Résumé?

A résumé is a short, straight-to-the-point, document created for the purpose of applying to a specific job.

Unlike the CV, you should try to keep a resume as short as possible. Fresh graduates should submit their résumé for job interview. A good résumé highlights specific contributions you have made in your previous work (project and internship) and showcases how your different skills can be useful for the position you are applying to.

The résumé is usually accompanied by the submission of a cover letter which states your intent for applying to the job. The cover letter builds upon the skills and experience you have touched upon in your résumé, explaining how they're going to help you excel at the job you're applying for.

1. Full name
2. Your [job title](#), or the name of the position you're applying for
3. Contact information
4. Resume summary or objective
5. Work experience (Project and Internship)
6. Education
7. Relevant skills
8. Languages and proficiency
9. Relevant certifications and interests (if any)

What to include on an entry-level engineer résumé

How to create an entry-level engineer Résumé?

Use these steps to guide you in creating an entry-level engineer resume:

1. Include your contact information

At the top of your resume, include your full name, phone number, email, location and links to professional networking websites. Placing this information in the header of your resume gives employers an easy way to reach you to schedule an interview or request further information from you.

2. Create an objective statement

3. Describe work experience

4. Include educational background

5. Add certifications

6. List relevant skills

Include skills that show hiring managers you can be a valuable asset to their company. Here are several skills you might include in your résumé:

Computer science

Problem-solving

Equipment knowledge

Analysis

Leadership

Teamwork

Attention to detail

Entry-level engineer resume template

4 Sections to Replace Work Experience [With Examples]

Now that you've listed your education, it's time to fill that work experience gap in your resume.

You aren't still worried about your lack of experience, right?

Because here are four sections you can use instead:

1) Internships

Have you done an internship that is relevant to the position you are applying for?

Now's the time to mention it.

Here is how you add an internship to your resume:

First, place the Internship section right after the education section.

Title it: Internships

Second, write your **internship title and role**. Be specific.

If your internship was in the marketing department, instead of just “Intern”, say “Marketing Intern”.

Third, put down the **company name, location, and duration of the internship** - in that order.

Internships

Marketing Intern

Full Picture Company

New York, NY

09/2019 - 12/2019

- Assisted the Marketing Manager in writing *press releases* and *new blog posts*, which increased web traffic by 25%.

Notice how the internship title remains the same.

But in this case you’re applying for a Content Writer position, so you are highlighting your writing experience instead.

Extracurricular activities

- ☐ **Title of the section:** Extracurricular Activities
- ☐ **Name of the organization and/or team**
- ☐ **Your role in the organization**
- ☐ **Time period**
- ☐ **Noteworthy awards or achievements**

Volunteering Experience

- ☐ **Title of the section:** Volunteering Experience
- ☐ **Name of the organization**
- ☐ **Location**
- ☐ **Time period**
- ☐ **Relevant tasks and achievements (bullet points)**

Extracurricular Activities

Public Speaking Club

Vice-President

09/2018 - 09/2019

- Organized 10+ public speaking lectures

- Brought in speakers from all over the state
- Conducted public speaking workshops

Volunteering Experience

Grand Archive Library Volunteer

Washington, D.C

08/2017 - 02/2019

- Performed secretarial activities, such as sorting mail, filing documents, answering phone calls, and taking messages.
- Led a poetry reading event twice a month.

Projects

In this section, you can add any relevant projects you were part of during your time in school or at an internship.

Types of Résumés

Which resume format is right for you?

There are three common resume formats: chronological, functional, and combination. The table below describes and gives the pros and cons of each. Use it to decide which is best for you.

Résumé Formats	Chronological Résumé	Functional or Skills-based Résumé	Combination Résumé
Overview	Lists your work history in reverse order, starting with your current or most recent job and working backwards.	Focuses on skills and strengths important to employers. Omits specific dates, names, and places. De-emphasizes a spotty work history.	Blends the flexibility and strength of the other two types of resumes.
Advantage	Easy to write. Emphasizes steady employment record. Employers like to see job	De-emphasizes a spotty work history. Allows you to highlight specific strengths	Shows off a strong employment record with upward

Résumé Formats	Chronological Résumé	Functional or Skills-based Résumé	Combination Résumé
	titles, level of responsibility, and dates of your work history.	and transferable skills that might not be obvious when outlined in purely chronological order.	mobility. Show how the skills you have used in the past apply to the job you are seeking. Emphasizes transferable skills.
Disadvantage	Calls attention to employment gaps. Skills can be difficult to spot unless they are listed in the most recent job.	No detailed work history. Content may appear to lack depth. Disliked by many employers. It makes them think you may be trying to hide your age, employment gaps, lack of relevant experience, lack of career progression, or underemployment.	Work history is often on the second page, and employer may not read that far.
Best used	To emphasize past career growth and development in the same career. Or when the name of a former employer may be significant to prospective employer.	To emphasize transferable skills you have used in volunteer work, paid work, or coursework. Use this or a combination resume if you are a new graduate, have limited work experience, are changing careers or doing freelance work, or you do not want to call	To show off your skills developed throughout your work history instead of the specific positions you have held. Use when you are making a career change and names of former employers

Résumé Formats	Chronological Résumé	Functional or Skills-based Résumé	Combination Résumé
		attention to your age.	may not be obvious to prospective employer.
Don't use if	There are gaps in your work history, when calling attention to your age could be a problem, you have changed jobs often, or you are entering the job market for first time or after a long absence.	You want to emphasize growth or development or if your duties and responsibilities in recent jobs were limited.	Your experience is limited, or there are wide gaps in your work history.
Résumé samples	Chronological (pdf) School to Work Chronological (pdf) Chronological Template (pdf): develop your resume	Skills Resume (pdf) Skills Resume Template (pdf): develop your resume	

Email writing tips

We rely heavily on email to communicate with colleagues, clients, vendors, etc. Some emails are far too long, stringing paragraph after paragraph together, while others are too brusque, while some are way too formal, or entirely too informal, and still others might even put the company in legal jeopardy.

Since we rely so heavily on email, every email we send should be well-written, and serve the intended purpose to disseminate information, while also being collegial. Effective emails, not only share information in a clear and concise manner, they save time and effort for both the reader and the recipient, which in the long run, impacts the bottom line.

Employ the following 12 tips to craft an effective email.

SUBJECT LINES ARE IMPORTANT

It drives me crazy when I get an email from someone and the subject line is a tease or does not relate to the content of the email. Again, this will add time to my day, when I'm trying to search through my emails for specific content, but the subject line doesn't match that content.

USE BULLET POINTS AND HIGHLIGHT CALL TO ACTION

Bullet points make it much easier for the recipient to read the email quickly and effectively. It also helps the reader identify the main points of the email. If the recipient is expected to do something after receiving the email, highlight the call to action.

How to Write an Email

1. Use a professional email address.
2. Have a compelling subject line.
3. Start with an appropriate greeting.
4. Have a strong attention grabber.
5. Keep your message concise.
6. Be consistent with your font.
7. Check the tone of your message.
8. Write a simple closing.
9. Use a professional signature.
10. Write the first draft with AI.
11. Practice email etiquette for each work situation.
12. Use CC and BCC fields wisely.
13. Schedule your emails.
14. Do a final spelling and grammar check.
15. Schedule a follow-up reminder.

Writing an effective email hinges on many factors:

- You have to get the recipient to open the email.
- Your email must make the intended impression on the reader while successfully relaying the intended message.
- It must drive the recipient to take the desired action.

1. Use a professional email address.

The first thing the recipient sees is your email address. First impressions matter. Sending an email from "Cutiepie245@gmail.com" to a hiring manager might give them the wrong impression about you and might create a bias against you. Always ensure that you send professional emails from a professional email address.

2. Have a compelling subject line.

Subject lines can make or break your email's success. It's often the deciding factor on whether someone will open your email.

Writing one compelling, concise, personalized, and attention-grabbing email can be challenging enough. Trying to do it at scale can be overwhelming..

BLOG WRITING

Writing a blog post is a little like driving;

How to Write a Blog Post in Five Easy Steps [Summary]:

Step 1: Planning

Step 2: Write your headline

Step 3: Draft your post

Step 4: Add images

Step 5: Edit your blog post

Now let's review each step in more detail.

How to Write a Blog Post, Step 1: Planning

First, a disclaimer – the entire process of writing a blog post often takes more than a couple of hours, even if you can type eighty words per minute and your writing skills are sharp. From the seed of the blog post idea to finally hitting “Publish,” you might spend several days or maybe even a week “writing” a blog post, but it's important to spend those vital hours planning your post and even thinking about your post (yes, thinking counts as working if you're a blogger) before you actually write it.

How to write a blog post planning stage?

Does your blog post have enough circles and crosses?

Long before you sit down to put digital pen to paper, you need to make sure you have everything you need to sit down and write. Many new bloggers overlook the planning process, and while you might be able to get away with skipping the planning stage, doing your homework will actually save you time further down the road and help you develop good blogging habits.

Read Your Post Aloud to Check Flow

This is a trick that many writers learn in workshops. If a piece reads awkwardly out loud, it will probably read awkwardly in your reader's mind. It might seem a bit weird, but force yourself to read your post aloud to check for wordy bottlenecks or contrived sentences. Find yourself struggling with the flow of a sentence? Rework it until it rolls off your tongue.

Analyze the tone and writing style of the competition.

Take note of your competition's copywriting. Is it something you feel like you can successfully emulate? Does it ring true to the type of blog you'd like to create? What do readers most respond to? For most, creating a tech blog might be an excellent idea, but if journalistic, review-based writing

doesn't work for you, then that might not be a good fit. Be aware of what you can feasibly execute or hire freelance writers.

3. Determine what topics you'll cover.

Before you write anything, pick a topic you'd like to write about. The topic can be pretty general to start as you find your desired niche in blogging.

Here are some ways to choose topics to cover.

Find out which topics your competitors often cover.

6 Free Blog Post Templates

Save time creating blog posts with these free templates.

"How-to" Post

"What is" Post

Listicle Post

And More!

Get Your Free Templates

Learn more

Determine the special problem you will solve for readers.

Your readers won't trust you or return to you unless you actively help them solve a problem. As you try to find your angle, think about ways you can help your audience surmount challenges typically associated with the topics you've chosen for your blog. For instance, if you're creating a blog about sustainability, then you might help readers learn how they can compost organic materials in their home.

6 Free Blog Post Templates

Save time creating blog posts with these free templates.

"How-to" Post

"What is" Post

Listicle Post

And More!

Get Your Free Templates

Learn more

What Is Netiquette?

Following internet etiquette, or netiquette, can help ensure you're being respectful to other online users. These guidelines are important when interacting with people online for various purposes, such as remote work, online classes and social media. Learning how to practice netiquette may help you communicate better and make connections digitally.

In this article, we explain what netiquette is, explain why it's important and provide 10 rules for practicing netiquette with examples.

What is netiquette?

Netiquette refers to internet guidelines that advise people on how to communicate and treat others when interacting online. These guidelines can apply to multiple aspects of the internet, such as email, message forums and video chats. Practicing netiquette is like practicing etiquette because both involve interacting with others respectfully. However, the rules for netiquette are specific to online communication.

It's also valuable to practice netiquette so you can communicate effectively with people like coworkers, classmates or teachers through online platforms. For example, you may find it important to know how to write a kind, professional email when inquiring about a job opportunity with a potential employer..

What is the Importance of Report Writing?

Reports are the backbone of effective communication in both academic and professional realms. Discover the significance of report writing in our blog on the Importance of Report Writing. Learn how mastering this skill can enhance your ability to convey information, influence decisions, and propel your career to new heights.

In a world fuelled by information, articulating ideas, findings, and insights is paramount. One medium that stands out as a cornerstone of effective communication is Report Writing. But where does the Importance of Report Writing lie in the dynamic world? To get the answer to this question, read this blog. Learn about the Importance of Report Writing and gain valuable insights into its pivotal role in your personal and professional lives.

Importance of Report Writing

Report Writing is a skill that can benefit you in various ways and contexts. Here is the list of reasons reflecting the Importance of Report Writing:

Evaluation

The importance of Report Writing can be reflected during the evaluation process. This is because Report Writing can help you evaluate your own or others' performance, progress, or outcomes. For example, if you are a student, you can write a Report to assess your learning outcomes, achievements, or challenges in a course or a project. As a teacher, you can write a Report to evaluate your students' learning outcomes, strengths, or weaknesses in a course or an assignment.

If you are a researcher, you can write a Report to evaluate your research methods, results, or implications in a study or an experiment. Report Writing can help you identify the gaps, strengths, or areas for improvement in your own or others' work.

Development of skills

Report Writing can help you develop your skills in various domains and disciplines. For example, if you are a student, you can write a Report to improve your writing, research, analysis, or presentation skills. If you are a teacher, you can write a Report to enhance your teaching, assessment, feedback, or curriculum design skills.

If you are a researcher, you can write a Report to advance your knowledge, methodology, innovation, or contribution skills. Report Writing can help you acquire new knowledge, apply existing knowledge, or create new knowledge in your field of interest.

Decision making tool

Report writing acts as a decision-making tool that can assist you in making decisions based on facts and evidence. For example, if you are a student, you can write a Report to support your arguments or opinions with data and sources in an essay or a debate. If you are a teacher, you can write a Report to justify your decisions or recommendations with data and sources in an assessment or feedback.

Conclusion

We hope that this blog has helped you understand the Importance of Report Writing and how to use it effectively. Report Writing is a skill that can benefit you in various ways and contexts. So, why not start writing Reports today? You will be amazed by the results!

Transform your potential into excellence - join our Personal Development Training and embark on a journey of self-improvement!

Four Types of Report Formats

Reports represent a way for those in a business to communicate facts, figures and information in a prepared, professional format. The size and scope of the report will depend on internal policy and protocols, as well as on the contents of the report and its intended usage. The objective is to create documents that are detailed and all-inclusive, and that deliver key points in a way that is informative and easy to understand.

Briefs always. Briefs should be short, but contain enough valuable information they can be distributed to others and serve a practical purpose.

What Is The Report Definition?

A report is a document that presents relevant business information in an organized and understandable format. Each report is aimed at a specific audience and business purpose, and it summarizes the development of different activities based on goals and objectives.

That said, there are various types of reports that can be used for different purposes. Whether you want to track the progress of your strategies or stay compliant with financial laws, there is a different report

for each task. To help you identify when to use them, we will cover the top 14 most common report formats used for businesses today.

1. Informational Reports

The first in our list of reporting types is informational reports. As their name suggests, this report type aims to give factual insights about a specific topic. This can include performance reports, expense reports, and justification reports, among others. A differentiating characteristic of these reports is their objectivity; they are only meant to inform but not propose solutions or hypotheses. Common informational reports examples are for performance tracking, such as annual, monthly, or [weekly reports](#).

2. Analytical Reports

This report type contains a mix of useful information to facilitate the decision-making process through a mix of qualitative and quantitative insights as well as real-time and historical insights. Unlike informational reports that purely inform users about a topic, this report type also aims to provide recommendations about the next steps and help with problem-solving. With this information in hand, businesses can build strategies based on analytical evidence and not simple intuition. With the use of the right [BI reporting tool](#), businesses can generate various types of analytical reports that include accurate forecasts via predictive analytics technologies. Let's look at it with an analytical report example.

3. Operational Reports

These reports track every pertinent detail of the company's operational tasks, such as its production processes. They are typically short-term reports as they aim to paint a picture of the present. Businesses use this type of report to spot any issues and define their solutions or to identify improvement opportunities to optimize their operational efficiency. [Operational reports](#) are commonly used in manufacturing, logistics, and retail as they help keep track of inventory, production, and costs, among others.

5. Industry Reports

Next in our list of the most common kinds of reports, we have industry-specific reports. Typically, these reports provide an overview of a particular industry, market, or sector with definitions, key trends, leading companies, and industry size, among others. They are particularly useful for businesses that want to enter a specific industry and want to learn how competitive it is or for companies who are looking to set performance benchmarks based on average industry values.

6. Department Reports

These reports are specific to each department or business function. They serve as a communication tool between managers and team members who must stay connected and work together for common goals. Whether it is the sales department, customer service, logistics, or finances, this specific report type helps track and optimize strategies on a deeper level. Let's look at it with an example of a team [performance report](#).

7. Progress Reports

From the brunch of informational reports, progress reports provide critical information about the status of a project. These reports can be produced on a daily, weekly, or monthly basis by employees or managers to track performance and fine-tune tasks for the better development of the project. Progress reports are often used as visual materials to support meetings and discussions. A good example is a [KPI scorecard](#).

As seen in the image above, this [IT dashboard](#) offers detailed information about different system indicators. For starters, we get a visual overview of the status of each server, followed by a detailed graph displaying the uptime & downtime of each week. This is complemented by the most common downtown issues and some ticket management information. Getting this level of insight helps your IT staff to know what is happening and when it is happening and find proper solutions to prevent these issues from repeating themselves. Keeping constant track of these metrics will ensure robust system performance.

1. Informational reports
2. Analytical reports
3. Operational reports
4. Product reports
5. Industry reports
6. Department reports
7. Progress reports
8. Internal reports
9. External reports

Technical Reports

A technical report can either act as a cherry on top of your project or can ruin the entire dough.

Everything depends on how you write and present it.

A technical report is a sole medium through which the audience and readers of your project can understand the entire process of your research or experimentation.

So, you basically have to write a report on how you managed to do that research, steps you followed, events that occurred, etc., taking the reader from the ideation of the process and then to the conclusion or findings.

What is a Technical Report? (Definition)

A technical report is described as a written scientific document that conveys information about technical research in an objective and fact-based manner. This technical report consists of the three key features of a research i.e process, progress, and results associated with it.

Some common areas in which technical reports are used are agriculture, engineering, physical, and biomedical science. So, such complicated information must be conveyed by a report that is easily readable and efficient.

A technical report is considered as a product that comes with your research, like a guide for it. You study the target audience of a product before creating it, right?

Similarly, before writing a technical report, you must keep in mind who your reader is going to be. Whether it is professors, industry professionals, or even customers looking to buy your project – studying the target audience enables you to start structuring your report. It gives you an idea of the existing knowledge level of the reader and how much information you need to put in the report.

Many people tend to put in fewer efforts in the report than what they did in the actual research. Which is only fair?

We mean, you've already worked so much, why should you go through the entire process again to create a report?

Well then, let's move to the second section where we talk about why it is absolutely essential to write a technical report accompanying your project.

Read more: [What is a Progress Report and How to Write One?](#)

Tips in Writing Technical Reports

Here are a few tips in writing the best technical reports you need:

1. Your technical report, above everything else, should convey information. This means that your main job as the author is to make sure that there will be no hindrance between your mind, your report's contents, and your reader understands. Every detail you incorporate into your report, every terminology you choose to use, should help you in your aim to make your readers comprehend. You may also see sample [activity reports](#).
2. Your technical report should also be stimulating and entertaining. This means that, as the author, your main antagonists are boredom and disinterest. These are two things you must overcome by keeping your tone lively yet factual, and your information fascinating.

However, if you were to choose between information and entertainment, you should always choose the former because, about the first guideline, this is your main job as the author.

3. Plan your technical report. Get a clear picture of what you want to say through it, and how you are going to say it in a way that will make your readers grasp the idea easier. It would also make things easier for you if you create a draft of your content first before you proceed to write it. You may also check out [incident report letter](#) examples.

Structure your data so that it will be easier for your audience to locate them. It is also best to remember that very few people will read your technical report from start to finish. Most of them will simply skim through the contents and decide whether they like it or not. This gives you about 4 minutes to get your point across. So when you are writing your technical report, arrange it in a way that your reader will easily understand the important parts in just 4 minutes. Take a look at the [service report](#) examples for more.

UNIT-3

ACTIVITIES ON PRESENTATION SKILLS

Starting a conversation and responding appropriately and relevantly:

Being able to start a meaningful conversation is an important skill that you can use to build and strengthen relationships. When you meet someone for the first time, you can make specific word choices to create a positive first impression. Establishing a list of conversation starters can also help you communicate with any person under any circumstances. In this article, we discuss how to start a conversation, explore 20 ways to start talking to a new person and share some examples of conversation starters for different situations.

How To Start A Conversation?

In the workplace, you can choose from a wide variety of topics on how to start a conversation as long as they are appropriate for the environment. Conversation starters with colleagues or professional contacts can look different than those with new friends or acquaintances. Your initial efforts can start a conversation that might help you build valuable relationships with coworkers and colleagues. Here are some of the best ways to start a conversation:

1. Ask a question

One effective tactic to start a conversation is asking a question to the person you want to speak to. Depending on the situation you are in, you can ask questions related to food, weather or anything that can start a conversation. Even if you know the answer to your question, it can be a great way to begin conversing with strangers.

Example: “Do you know who is going to speak after the company's president has addressed the audience?”

2. Give a compliment

Complimenting someone whom you have met for the first time can lead to an ongoing and pleasant conversation. You can pick anything about the person you like and say something nice about them.

Example: “Your presentation was very inspiring and informational.”

Related: How to Praise Someone Professionally (With 51 Examples)

3. Talk about an event or situation

Identify something interesting in your surroundings and talk about it. For instance, if you are at a business conference, you can share your views on the conference with the person sitting next to you. If you are in a coffee shop, you can talk about your favourite coffee to the person next to you in line.

Example: "My favourite shake is the Belgium chocolate shake topped with whipped cream and ice cream. What is yours?"

Related: Conversation Skills: Importance And Tips To Improve

4. Ask an opinion

To start a conversation with someone you do not know, you can ask someone's opinion on a particular topic. When you give importance to the opinions of others, you can showcase your willingness to talk to that person.

Example: "I am looking for comfortable sports shoes. Can you recommend brands that offer comfortable and affordable shoes?"

How to Use Role Play

It is easy to set up and run a role-playing session. It will help to follow the five steps below.

Step 1: Identify the Situation

To start the process, gather people together, introduce the problem, and encourage an open discussion to uncover all of the relevant issues. This will help people to start thinking about the problem before the role-play begins.

If you're in a group and people are unfamiliar with each other, consider doing some icebreaker exercises beforehand.

Step 2: Add Details

Next, set up a scenario in enough detail for it to feel "real." Make sure that everyone is clear about the problem that you're trying to work through, and that they know what you want to achieve by the end of the session.

Step 3: Assign Roles

Once you've set the scene, identify the various fictional characters involved in the scenario. Some of these may be people who have to deal with the situation when it actually happens (for example, salespeople). Others will represent people who are supportive or hostile, depending on the scenario (for example, an angry client).

Once you've identified these roles, allocate them to the people involved in your exercise; they should use their imagination to put themselves inside the minds of the people that they're representing. This involves trying to understand their perspectives, goals, motivations, and feelings when they enter the situation. (You may find the Perceptual Positions technique useful here.)

Below is a list of ideas for a general English class. This can be adapted to suit a situation.

Try These Fun and Fresh Role Play Activities with Your Class

1 Telephone Conversation

Speaking on the phone is different from a face-to-face conversation because one relies solely on language to communicate. Get the students who are practicing to sit back to back in order for this to work properly. There is a whole range of ideas that one can use to act this out. Examples include: phoning to make a complaint, speaking to a friend or inquiring about a job position. Other ideas can include speaking to a customer support agent about a broken time machine, or being trapped in an elevator with your favorite celebrity and you're phoning your friend to tell them.

2 Going to the Shop

A great one for younger learners as it will teach them the basics of interacting with people. Children generally rely on their parents to buy things for them, therefore, this will boost their overall general confidence in buying. It can be as simple or as complex as one wishes, depending on the situation. Key phrases are often important here, such as "I would like..." "How much are..." "Good morning..." and so forth. For some extra fun, Santa now has a telephone number and you're calling to tell him how good you've been and what you'd like for Christmas. You can shake up the kind of shop your students visit, for example You've traveled 1,000 years into the future and visit a corner store. What will you buy?

I never ask someone what they do anymore. Instead, I ask how they spend their time. Questions like this one open the door to more interesting conversations. If the person's initial response is work-related, I follow up with, "What do you do when you're not working?" Just keep asking questions and share comments that relate their story to yours.

If you are talking with someone and another guest looks a little uncomfortable, remember the times when you were that uncomfortable person and try to include others by inviting them into the conversation.

Here are few tips that could help you crack this round.

1. Simple Vocabulary:

Try to avoid long sentences and language with complex vocabulary. Interviewers generally look for simple English. In an attempt to use impressive words, you might fail to drive your point to the panel members. What is important is content. Besides content pay attention to details like grammar, pronunciation, and sentence formation.

2. Preparation:

JAM is all about spontaneity but a little smart work could help you crack JAM. Invariably some topics are always a part of the JAM topics like - Engineering is a right platform to take-off for a bright career, Are Engineering Colleges really producing professionals? or Technical fests in Engineering Colleges, all these are relevant topics you can have a look at before your JAM session. Current Affairs is something that you need to prepare for before JAM, there is a high possibility for such topics. By preparing for topics your confidence levels might build up and help you be familiar with the approach.

3. Avoid Repetition:

One of the common mistake that students commit during the JAM sessions and subsequently lose marks is they repeat the ideas and sentences. Try to provide as many new ideas as possible in one minute. Speaking uninterrupted is essential but that does not mean you will repeat the sentences or ideas, you might gain a negative impression there.

4. Avoid Mother Tongue Influence:

Try to avoid Mother tongue Influence at maximum; this will create impression on you. Use proper diction, do not try to fake an accent, that is where you will lose the attention. Be yourself and be clear.

Exercise 1 – Learning to relax

Find a comfortable place and lie on the floor. Close your eyes and concentrate on relaxing every part of your body, starting with your feet and legs and working upwards to your shoulders, neck and head. Now bring your attention to your breathing. To begin with, just be aware of breathing in and out.

Now try to imagine a place that you can associate with calmness. Picture this place and hear the sounds, smell the smells.

Once you have become familiar with recalling this special place, it can be somewhere to go whenever you are feeling nervous – such as just before you go on stage to make a speech.

Learning to relax takes time but it will really help, especially if you do this exercise regularly. After a while, you'll be able to recall the feelings of relaxation anywhere.

Exercise 2 – Canter your yourself

Stand with your feet shoulder-width apart, your hands hanging loose, shoulders down and head relaxed on your neck.

First, try to collect your thoughts and think in your head. Feel yourself become lighter.

Now try to think in your stomach, and start to feel yourself getting rooted in the ground. You are effectively 'thinking your centre of gravity' down through your body. This process is called 'cantering' and it may take a little practice.

Now breathe in, and feel the breath going right down into your centre, i.e., to the bottom of your lungs and into your stomach. Breathe out allowing your diaphragm to control the outward breath.

Exercise 3 – Get to know your space

Nerves often come from the unknown, so go to the room or hall where you will be speaking, and walk around it, rehearsing your speech out loud. Now sing parts of your speech and move around allowing your voice to fill the space.

Presentations through posters/project/reports:

1. Plan ahead

Work with your mentor! Start your preparation well in advance. Procrastination can lead to stress and a rushed presentation. Here's a suggested timeline:

Months before: Determine the presentation date and guidelines. Choose your research topic and gather data.

Weeks before: Create an outline and design your poster. Begin drafting content and figures.

Days before: Finalize your poster and practice your presentation.

SPEAKER: Like one of the important things is working with your mentors and having them double check your work. Going through and reading a lot of different studies also helped me to get some background in the area of research. I'm relatively new to this area of research, so I didn't have a lot of information.

So just looking at various studies, maybe-- even if they're not directly related to what you're looking at just helps you develop some of that background knowledge necessary for the research. And then, like I said, working with your mentor really helps a lot.

2. Design a clear and engaging poster

Layout and Format

CRL provides a poster template.

Email crlstaff@iupui.edu for poster design advice.

Content

POSTER PRESENTATION

At most meetings or conferences, when you present a poster presentation, it means that you will display your poster and be available for viewers to ask questions about your research and how it is represented on your poster. Like an oral presentation delivered with a slideshow, there are many ways to design and present your research on a poster. There are also, however, a few important considerations and conventions to be familiar with.

For In-person Posters Only

Create a poster presentation; print and trim final version to a size of 40" x 32" (102 cm x 81 cm); landscape or portrait orientation

Prepare a short pitch discussing the poster presentation (less than 3 minutes is recommended)

Share your work with visitors and evaluators

Developing a Poster Presentation

A poster presentation is a visual presentation of your research that often includes a concise display of the abstract, purpose, method, significant literature, results, and graphs or tables.

Follow these basic rules for creating a poster that an audience will want to explore.

Know your audience. In general, your audience members will fall into one of two groups:

People who don't know anything about your topic. This audience gives you an opportunity to teach them about the interesting information you've been learning and to convince them that the kind of work you are is important and has relevance.

People who know and understand your topic. Some people will be familiar with the basic concepts you're working with, but don't assume that they are familiar with all of the technical details.

Determine your take-home message.

What is the single most important thing you want your audience to understand, believe, accept, or do after they see your poster?

Include a succinct statement of your project's main argument, and the evidence that supports that argument.

Choose a few key pieces of evidence that most clearly illustrate your take home message. Use visuals to distill and communicate your take-home message quickly and easily.

EFFECTIVE PRESENTATIONS CHECKLIST

Create a shared meaning between the you, the speaker, and your audience

Having the knowledge and skills to effectively design and deliver a dynamic presentation is essential in the academic and professional world, regardless of field. Most colleges and universities require students to complete a public speaking course. In addition, many large organizations send employees to training course to develop their skills in this area. Why is it so important for college students and employees to be effective in this context?

The bottom line is that presentations are used to create a shared meaning between the speaker and the audience. Whether it is to inform peers of the results of your course project, communicate changes in the organization, provide updates on projects to your boss and co-workers, persuade the organization to invest in new technology, convince the city council to reduce waste, or recognize the accomplishments of a valued employee, the goal of a presentation needs to be accomplished. By using strategic design and delivery techniques, you increase your chances of accomplishing your goal. In addition, your successful efforts will leave others with a positive impression of your communication and leadership skills.

While there are a tremendous number of resources available on the internet to assist individuals wanting to increase the effectiveness of their presentations, the following checklist provides the basic things you should consider. This checklist contains items that are included within UMN Crookston's Public Speaking course (SPCH 1101).

1. What are the logistical considerations/constraints of the speaking event?

If you don't know the answers to the questions below, ask the person inviting you to speak. Although the following is not an exhaustive list, it may help you determine other questions you want to ask:

What is the occasion/event that I'll be speaking at (purpose)?

Where is the presentation located?

How many people will be in the audience?

What is the start time for my presentation?

How much time do I have to speak? Does that include time for questions?

What should I wear?

2. Know your audience.

The more you know about your audience, the more you can tailor your presentation to them, thus making it more relevant and increasing your likelihood of accomplishing your goal. If you don't know the answers to the questions below, ask the person inviting you to speak. Although the following is not an exhaustive list, it may help you determine other questions you want to ask:

Who will be in the audience (position, demographics, etc.)?

How much to the audience know about the presentation topic?

What is the audience's overall attitude towards the topic?

3. What is the purpose of the presentation?

The answer to this question will help you determine how to organize your presentation as well as choose the appropriate content. If you don't know the answers to the questions below, ask the person inviting you to speak. Although the following is not an exhaustive list, it may help you determine other questions you want to ask:

Is the purpose to inform the audience?

UNIT-4

ACTIVITIES ON GROUP DISCUSSION

Objectives

Students develop ability to:

- Enhance team spirit and lead a team
- Understand the strengths and weaknesses of the team members
- Evaluate their self-performance and refine their Oral Skills

Introduction

“Man is a social Animal” to quote Aristotle, the great philosopher. Every individual has thoughts and these thoughts/ideas are addressed /expressed to oneself in monologues or conveyed to others in dialogues. Communication is both Verbal and Non-verbal. One aspect of Verbal Communication is through Group Discussion.

A Group Discussion (GD) is an interactive, oral communication which takes place when a group of people get together and discuss but do not debate. Each participant expresses ideas about a particular topic gently, coolly and clearly in an objective manner.

Group discussions can be categorized as: a) Informal and b) Formal.

An Informal Group Discussion takes place when a group of friends talk about things in general in college canteen, outside the classroom, at a bus stop or any other place, when a family interacts/interactions about various issues or when a group of people talk about different matters, such as sports, train travel, price rise, examinations, favorite film stars, current affairs, etc. In these informal discussions, each one freely expresses his/her views on the subject.

In formal contexts, structured group discussions are increasingly used as a tool to identify candidates with the right abilities, either for employment or for admission to various courses. As the term itself suggests, a GD is a discussion, but not a debate. What is actually expected in a GD is participation in a systematic discussion, expressing opinions on a particular topic and presenting different views.

There are two kinds of GDs- Structured and Unstructured.

Structured GD is formal which is usually conducted in placements, classrooms, Board Rooms, etc., where each participant mentally structures the thoughts, words about the given topic in a phased manner depending on time and chance one decides to speak. Here the Verbal and Non-verbal Communication is judged by Evaluators or Moderators.

An Unstructured GD is informal in which anyone in the group can speak at any point of time without disturbing the general decorum of the discussion. The family get-together, canteen talks, chats in the airports, railway stations etc. are examples of such discussions. However in any GD it is advantageous for the participant to cultivate a Civilized Approach, use the right words and proper body language so that it becomes a part and parcel of one's life. The prospect of participating in a GD tends to leave good number of participants who are petrified. You can dispel that fear by the experience you are exposed while participating in a Group Discussions. Remember those discussions across the dinner table with family members, friends and relatives in/on various occasions. GD is an open discussion and not a debate between the members of a group.

Uses of a GD

1. To express important thoughts/points about a given topic.
2. To express/tell facts about the topic with justification.
3. To develop oratory skills.
4. To drive away/overcome inhibitions.
5. To share opinions.
6. To arrive at positive/general consensual conclusions.

The main areas of a GD are

1. Subject knowledge about current affairs, politics, social issues, economic issues, scientific and environmental problems like climate change, etc.
2. Systematic Analysis of the content to prove the stated point of view.
3. Listening, language, expression, articulation, pronunciation and body language.
4. Leadership skills like initiation, assertiveness, self-confidence, persuasiveness, patience, motivation.
5. Team Management Skills like adaptability, positive thinking, cooperation, coordination and correcting attitudinal lapses in the group.

Dynamics of GD

1. The opening of a GD should be attractive and direct the course of discussion.
2. Logical Approach plays an important role.
3. Plan a strategy to express appropriately...
4. The motivator or the leader of a group should roll the topic on, avoiding pauses.
5. The leader should see that bitter arguments and personal comments are avoided.
6. Understanding the topic from all possible angles.
7. Summing up is very important for a good GD.
8. Proper body language, eye contact and gestures make a GD effective.
9. Use PREP formula (preparation, reason, example and position).

Some useful and encouraging phrases to intervene effectively in a GD

- **Agreeing:** You are absolutely right, I agree to/with your point of view
- **Disagreeing:** I am sorry, I don't see it in that way/my point is-----
- **Interrupting:** Sorry, do you mind, if I say something here?, excuse me, would you listen to-
- **Dealing with interruptions:** Could I just finish with what I am saying?, let me say---
- **Asking for information:** Would you mind elaborating/saying a little more about it?
- **Adding more information:** Another point I would like to make or add is.....

Time Management for a GD.

For example if the GD is for 15 minutes

- Chaos period (1-2 minutes).
- Ice breaker (1 minute).
- Generating ideas (1 minute).
- Discussion on the ideas (10 minutes).

- Conclusion (1 minute).

Strategies for effective Group Discussion

1. The opening sentences should create enthusiasm and interest among the listeners, usually by the use of appropriate quotations, proverbs, statements, epigrammatic sentences/punch lines..
2. Systematic and coherent presentation of the content.
3. Body gestures or Non-verbal Communication should be balanced.
4. Balancing the points of discussion while contradicting a statement.
5. Anticipating possible disruptions.
6. Express softly/politely but do not be a silent spectator/listener.
7. Be Open-minded.
8. Conclude the GD cheerfully recapitulating the ideas.

Do's of a GD

- Listen to every speaker carefully.
- Put your thoughts in order.
- Initiate the discussion once you are through with the subject.
- Support your point with facts and figures.
- Give others a chance to speak and respect their contribution.
- Disagree politely.
- Summarize coherently.

Don'ts of GD

- Initiate the discussion with insufficient knowledge about the given topic.
- Pose negative body gestures like sitting crossed arms and legs, sitting stiff,
- Scratching or rubbing the nose, leaning back in the chair, fidgeting etc.
- Tell irrelevant points and distract the discussion.
- Expressing anger or uncontrollable laughter.
- Over speak or intervene without proper vocabulary.
- Argue or shout.
- Pass personalized comments.
- Mention intercultural or socio economic background of any participant.
- Produce individualized comments.

A few expressions used in GD

Activity	Expression
1. Lead the discussion	i. It is not difficult to understand the problem but..... ii. The actual point of discussion is.... iii. Dear friend, don't deviate-----
2. Draw someone into discussion	i. What is your opinion about this? ii. Do you agree, if I say...? iii. May I draw your attention... .?
3. Refocus the discussion	i. Can you speak something..... ii. Can you elaborate

- | | |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 4. Help someone to participate | i. Please continue..... |
| | ii. Could you explain..... |
| 5. Make suggestions | i. Could you speak like this ? |
| | ii. Can you give details...? |
| 6. Conclude | i. At the end, I can state..... |
| | ii. To sum up, I mention..... |
| | iii. To conclude, I say..... |

It is essential that GDs should be practiced consciously and continuously in all conversations upgrading the vocabulary, intonation, knowledge, proper Body-language, etc. as this enhances the personal traits of every candidate in Personality Development. Participation in GD is a sure cure for people who are afraid of public speaking, introverts, people who are reluctant to come out of their respective shells or hesitate to come out of their comfort zones or from the 'frog in a well' syndrome. GD liberates them from all these kinds of bottle necks or draw backs.

Body Language

Our facial gestures, limb movements and mannerisms play a vital role in effecting GD, which is nothing but body Language or Non-Verbal Communication. We may offend anyone if we are not careful about our body language when we are in GD. Positive Body gestures show one's confidence and enhance their self-image. The following are the points to remember about Body Language while participating in GDs.

1. Correct body postures encourage discussion and avoid distractions.
2. Often body language conveys lot of information which words fail to convey.
3. Sitting upright and moving hands not too heavily indicate good manners.
4. Builds good rapport with others in the discussion.
5. Helps to understand what others want to express.
6. Good body postures and gestures avoid conflicts in discussion.
7. Good body language controls aggression among the participants.
8. It controls conflicts arising.

9. Parameters for Evaluation

Group Discussions are conducted to evaluate not only the candidate's Verbal and Non-verbal skills but also the other personality traits like ideals, honesty in expression, motivational aspects commitment to oneself and society, truthfulness, psychological thought process, transparency and all other soft skills and leadership skills. Each organization will have its own parameters of Evaluation.

In general the components of Evaluation for GDs (rubric):

1. Communication Skills.
2. Knowledge. (Preparation)
3. Organization of thoughts.
4. Cooperation with others.
5. Leadership Skills or initiative.
6. Persuasion Skills.
7. Use of gathered information.
8. Problem solving.
9. Team work.

You tube links on Group discussions

1. https://youtu.be/qymUH_pzPXc
2. <https://youtu.be/YY2yjEEoB3U>
3. <https://youtu.be/-lXjbph22Ek>

Outcomes

By the end of the module, the students would be able to:

- Participate in Group Discussions expressing ideas pleasantly, relevantly, coherently and cogently.
- Develop strategies to improve their soft skills on an on-going basis lifelong.
- Conduct oneself in a decent and dignified manner in various (Professional and personal situations even under stress).
- Remain calm and composed all through to listen and participate.
- Exhibit cultural sensitivity.

ACTIVITY

Group Discussion Topics

Students participate in discussion and record the same.

4. Environmental Protection-Human Responsibility
5. Yoga and Lifestyle only can cure health disorders
6. 'Mars Mission' Is it justified?
7. Law should be an instrument of Social Change.
8. Foreign direct investments in local business- Is it good or bad for our country?
9. Visual aids are dangerous tools.
10. Human Diseases are man-made.
11. Indian Democracy.
12. Rural Development in India.
13. Impact of Covid 19 on Human Life.

Unit-5

Interview Skills

Objectives

Students develop ability to

- Face Interviews Confidently
- Participate well in Placement Drives
- Plan for a good career
- Understand the strategies to perform excellently in Interviews

- Succeed in securing Jobs

Interview is an opportunity to meet the challenges of professional life on the one hand and to score well to acquire placements on the other. If the applicant wants to exhibit skills, knowledge, self-confidence and motivation to secure employment, interview is the only way. Interview Skills/performance determines the caliber of the candidate. In an Interview the various parameters are applied to gauge the capabilities of the candidates to select/recruit the right person. The guiding factor is 'Right candidate for the Right job'. It is a form of Formal verbal and Non-Verbal Communication between the Interviewer and Interviewee which proves the unique identity of the applicant.

Every interview has a process involving the following steps:

1. Type of interview
2. How to start an interview
3. Establishing rapport
4. Exchanging information
5. Closing the interview
6. Follow-up after the interview
7. Conclusion

Points to ponder about an Interview Process from the point of view of the employer

Open the interview process with an 'Ice Breaker' session to put the candidate at ease

1. Arrangement/Fixing date, time, place and preparing a questionnaire
2. Eliciting relevant personal information as much as possible without infringing on privacy
3. Recording full information on academic qualifications(duly supported certificates)
4. Gathering job related information and knowledge to ascertain whether the candidate meets all the requirement of the position opted
5. Assessing SWOC (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Challenges)
6. Evolve and analyze the interview strategies – Gather performance evaluation by the previous Senior Employers, number of rounds of interview, selecting the Interview Panel, One-to-one interview by seniors of the Company, make credential checks discretely and confidentially, ascertain during the interview whether the candidate is willing to give a bond. Final offer may be given.
7. Evaluate whether the candidate fits into the slot. Avoid square peg fitting into a round hole. Make a 360 degree analysis in terms of (a) Mental make up (mindset) (b) Physical Stamina (c) Competence, (d) Communication skills (e) Commitment (e) Judgment (f) Job Knowledge (g) Work experience (h) Inter-personal skills (i) Past Achievements, **(j) Goal Orientation (k) Consistency (l) Team Spirit/Team Player/Team Builder (m) Ability to handle HR issues (n) any other relevant aspect.**

Planning for the interview

After sending Résumé to a company, the candidate will get a call/call-letter from the hiring

manager. The interview may be either a Telephonic Interview or Face-to-face physical Interview. Telephonic interviews give a chance to the employer to examine the candidate's skill sets on conversing. Face-to-face interviews are usually conducted if the candidate is selected in the initial Telephone interview. Mostly the Face-to-face interviews are based on asking questions relevant to the job or to the person by an interviewer or a panel of members.

The opening strategies of an Interview

There are **two stages**:

- 1. Introduction:** The best way to enter an interview room is to knock, ask for permission to enter and then wait for a while before sitting. Try to be comfortable, do not place your hands on the table. Maintain a correct posture and display confidence.
 - a. Be presentable, maintain time, be calm and composed and give appropriate answers.
 - b. Maintain eye contact.
 - c. Introduce yourself clearly.
 - d. Smile but do not laugh.
 - e. Be expressive. Avoid using monotone.
 - f. Pronounce the words clearly.
 - g. Be concise.
 - h. Be focused and answer to the point
 - i. Be direct in answering.
 - j. Use appropriate hand gestures to emphasize key points.
 - k. Negotiate well.
- 2. Attitude and Response:** Interviewers will give a lead to the candidates. So try and take cues from the tonal variations, facial expressions and questions of the employer. Prepare brief sentences to express your -
 - a. Family background.
 - b. Education.
 - c. Initiation.
 - d. Inter personal skills.
 - e. Aptitude.
 - f. Extracurricular Skills like - Sports, Arts, Community Service etc.

Your holistic analysis of yourself should be portrayed in Interviews.

In any interview there are three stages: Pre-Interview, Interview process and Post Interview

1. Pre - interview

- Identify your strengths, weaknesses, goals and skills, etc.
- Make a thorough study of the company – Management, Products, Location, Finance, Labour, HR policies, Market demand etc.
- Rehearse what you plan to say.
- Practice answers to common questions.
- Prepare questions to enquire about the Organization.

2. Interview Process

- Make sure you report fifteen to thirty minutes before the schedule.

- Be aware of Non-verbal communication. Sit straight, look alert, speak clearly and audibly but stay relaxed. Maintain good eye contact, avoid nervous mannerisms, and try to be a good listener as well as a good speaker. Smile.
- Follow the interviewer's lead, so that you can relate your background and skills to suit the context.
- Be specific, concrete, and detailed in your answers. More information you volunteer, the better the employer will know you. However, ensure you answer to the point.
- Offer examples of your previous work and references which will document best qualities in you.
- Answer questions as truthfully and frankly as you can. Answer honestly. Try not to say more than necessary.

3. Post interview

- Take notes on what you feel you could improve upon for your next interview.
- Write a brief thank-you letter to the interviewer.
- If offered the position, depending on your availability and professional viability take a decision. The Offer letter should be respected and accepted. Do not forget to thank.

Preparing for an Interview

Research is a critical part of preparing for an interview. Spend time in thinking about yourself and the questions you might ask at the end of interview. Self-assessment will enable you to know what you have to offer to an employer. It is very important to develop an inventory of skills, experience and personal attributes that can be used to 'sell yourself' to prospective employers.

Following is a list of marketable skills which are generic in nature.

- Analytical/Problem solving skills.
- Flexibility/Versatility.
- Interpersonal relationships.
- Oral/Written communication.
- Organization/Planning.
- Time management.
- Motivation.
- Leadership.
- Self-starter/Initiative.
- Team player.

Types of interviews

1. Face-to-face physical interview through pre-determined dates or Walk-in Interviews.
2. Group interview.
3. Behavioral interview.
4. Telephonic interview.
5. Panel interview.
6. Stress interview.
7. Video Conferencing.

Face to face interview: This is also known as traditional interview. In this kind of interview the employer and the job seeker can get to know each other about respective environment.

Group Interview: These interviews are conducted by large companies or MNC's for graduates at a time, either directly or through outsourced Placement portals. They may give some exercises to solve in a group and observe the leadership and communication skills of the participants. These interviews test the team work, listening comprehension and stress managing skills among the group.

Behavioral Interview: In this, the candidates are asked to explain their skills, experience, hobbies, projects and personal details. The interviewers will be analyzing and assessing the candidate's capabilities and body language during such interviews.

Telephone Interview: These are to reduce the expenses of reaching the spot and cost-cutting approach by the employers, both for the Interviewee and the Interviewer.

Panel interviews: The candidates will interact with several higher authorities and answer the questions posed by a panel of members. Usually this method is used to hire for top positions.

Stress interview: The main purpose of this interview is to test the candidate's ability to handle stress situations. The employer will ask continuous questions to answer without giving time to think. The interviewer might openly challenge beliefs or judgments. Sometimes impossible tasks are given to test the candidate's abilities.

Interview through Video-conferencing

Interviews are also held through video-conferencing. This is very akin to a face-to face job interview because the interviewers can watch the candidate answering the questions, and can also assess his/her behavior and the candidate's communication skills. Some organizations prefer to have a screening interview through video-conferencing. The video-conferencing interview follows a fixed structure. The number of interviewers varies from one to eight. The Chairperson of the selection committee introduces the members of the committee to the candidate. Each expert will be analyzing the candidate's candidature.

Tips to succeed in interviews:

- Keep all necessary certificates/documents in a file.
- Be confident.
- Be a good listener.
- Dress petite. (Formal)
- Switch off the cell phone.
- Keep control on body movements.
- Maintain eye contact.
- Don't give pauses.
- Smile. (its your greatest asset)

Types of Questions

There are mainly seven types of questions that occur during interviews.

1. Open questions: Asked in the beginning of an Interview to motivate the candidates to feel at home. Eg. Introduce yourself , mention your areas of interests, your family background, your Role-models etc.
2. Closed questions: To limit the scope of responses with specific answers. Eg. What is Data processing?
3. Probing questions: To test the deeper understanding of the subject. Eg. Do you think recession in 2020 might help the Developed and Underdeveloped Countries?
4. Reflective questions: To confirm the candidate's statements. Eg. Do you want the public sector companies be privatized?
5. Loaded questions: To judge the abilities. Eg. You live in Telangana. Will you be able to relocate to Kolkata? You are too short. Don't you think this is going to be a handicap for you?
6. Hypothetical questions: To test the problem solving capacity. Eg. Can you calculate and give a statistical data regarding the Literacy Rate in Telangana ?
7. Leading questions: To know the desired response. Eg. What is your opinion about the Economic Status of our Country after Covid-19? What is your opinion about TRP ratings?

General HR interview questions with possible answers:

1. How would you describe yourself?

My background to date has been centered on preparing myself to become a productive(mention the specific Branch) Engineer I can become. I was born and raised inI have worked for(Mention the name of the Organisation worked, designation, years of experience, Projects taken up, any other specific recognition.).. I represented National/State as(like Cricket Captain, Chess, Football, Hockey etc.) and learnt languages like English, Telugu, Hindi, Spanish, German (mention any language learnt through You-tube like Mandarin(Chinese),Japanese etc. .The Programming languages learnt are JAVA, PYTHON etc.

2. What specific goals, including those related to your occupation, have you established for your life?

I want to be working for an excellent company like yours. I plan to contribute my leadership, interpersonal, and technical skills. My long-term career goal is to contribute as much as I can during my tenure to the progress of the company and for my career development.

3. How has your college experience prepared you for this career?

I have prepared myself to enter into the work force through real-world experience involving travel abroad, internship, and entrepreneurial opportunities which were given to me at our college. As you can see from my academic, extracurricular and experiential background, I have unconditionally committed myself to success as an Engineering Professional.

4. What influenced you to choose this career?

I like engineering because I know my potential. I possess dedication and determination to

reach my professional goals. It is my aptitude.

5. Do you have the qualifications and personal characteristics necessary for success in your chosen career?

I believe I have a combination of qualities to be successful in this career. First, I have a strong interest, backed by a solid, well-rounded, state-of the-art education, especially in a career that is technically oriented. I am convinced that I possess these characteristics and am ready to be a successful team member of your firm.

6. Are you more energized by working with data or by collaborating with other individuals?

I like the validity of information and also like the energy that comes from collaborative work. The best thing about working in a group is combining the minds from different perspectives and coming up with something extremely great - synergy. At the same time, information can generate vitality in the project you're working on.

7. How would you describe yourself in terms of your ability to work as a member of a team?

I have had opportunities in both academics and athletics to develop skills as a team player. I have experience of being a team leader to do a project. I maintained excellent communication among group members and coordinated towards reaching our team goals.

8. Would you describe yourself as goal-driven?

Yes. I demonstrated my goal orientation as President of the local Community Service Center. I am proud of the fact that I set a goal of signing 50 new members this year and accomplished it.

9. Can you describe your long-range goals and objectives?

My primary objective is to learn as much as possible about your company and learn Professional Techniques to excel in the position I am offered. My long-range goal is to motivate my team members, work exceptionally well.

10. What do you expect to do in the next five years?

Although it is hard to predict future, I sincerely believe that I will become a successful engineer. My aim is to reach a position in the company where I can take on new challenges and would be able to improve organizational growth.

11. How would you evaluate your ability to deal with conflict?

Yes. I believe that I am good at handling it. I accomplish what I need, from the tasks given.

12. Would you say that you can easily deal with high pressure situations?

Yes. My past experiences gave me the courage to deal with serious situations effectively attending to emergency on-call duties also.

13. Do you think that your grades are an indication of your academic achievements?

I have focused on gaining real- world experience. Sometimes my heavy load has not

allowed me to keep up with my studies, but my experience can be applied in my future endeavor.

14. Describe the characteristics of a successful leader?

A successful leader should have vision, formulate strategies and communicates to the team members. He/she should be one who knows the way, shows the way and goes in that way.

15. Tell me what do you know about our company?

I browsed in detail about your company the various Departments associated, the HR Approaches , Production Strategies, Labour Welfare Schemes etc. and you have excellent track record and won many National and International Awards to your Credit. This motivates me to join the Organization.

16. Which is more important to you, the job or salary?

Salary commensurate with my experience and skills.

17. How do you determine priorities in scheduling your time?

I follow Time Management skills. I list the works as per their importance and complete the work.

18. Tell me about a time you had to handle multiple responsibilities?

While attending the college, I worked as a part timer in another firm and was successful. As a student, I was coordinator for cultural, literary and sports committees

19. What is your greatest strength?

My hard work and time management skills. I work well under pressure to reach the deadlines. My weakness is I am a workaholic.

20. Do you have any questions to ask us?

Can I know about the expansion avenues in Production, Geographical distribution etc. of your Organization in future?

21. What motivates you?

My commitment to my career, the projects, my family, the society I live in etc. along with Recognition and Promotion.

22. What is your definition of success?

Success is 'never giving up' attitude. Every failure is a stepping stone towards success.

23. Why should we hire you?

Mention and explain the Projects you have guided.

I was the Team-leader for the Project (mention the details of the Project-Name, Purpose ,Finance, Time-span etc.).

I have the required qualifications (mention the specific educational qualifications and certified Software Programs done and mention additional laurels likes Awards,outstanding projects taken up etc.) I think, I am the best and most appropriate person possessing all the necessary skills for this job.

24. If we offer you the job, how would you react?

It would be a pleasant surprise Sir! I am much pleased and would like to inform you that I would serve this Organization to the best of my capabilities and bring Productive results. I shall always walk the extra mile.

25. Define yourself in one word and justify.

Hardworking-I have completed B.Tech./M. Tech./Ph.D from the reputed Institution. I have put in

- i) five years of consistent service in Wipro.
- ii) Adaptability-Worked in Digboi Oil Refineries in Gauhati /DELL Bangalore/Perth Australia. I can work in a Multicultural Environment.

Outcomes

By the end of the module, the students would be able to:

- Develop holistic skills to improve their behavioral patterns while attending Interviews.
- Learn more about the strategies required in gaining confidence to navigate themselves to attend various Types of Interviews.
- Enhance their speaking skills to face Interviews boldly.

Activities

1. Conducting Mock Interviews.
2. Showing videos of various Job Interviews.
3. Giving sample questions from the previous Interviews and answering them.

a) <https://youtu.be/OhJWg-0qdI0>

b) <https://youtu.be/lsJBGvyiAHI>

